D.K.T.E. Society's Textile and Engineering Institute, Ichalkaranji

(An Autonomous Institute, Affiliated to Shivaji University, Kolhapur)

Accredited with 'A+' Grade by NAAC



Promoting Excellence in
Teaching, Learning & Research

Department of Computer Science and Engineering
(Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning) 2026-2027.

THE COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT PROJECT REPORT ON

"DIGITAL LITERACY FOR SENIOR CITIZENS"

Under the guidance of: Miss.S.S.Demanna

Developed By:

1. Pranav Mane 25UAM105
2. Sanskar Gorave 25UAM126
3. Shubham Khavare 25UAM102
4. Suyash Mali 25UAM107

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that,

1. Pranav Mane	25UAM105
2. Sanskar Gorave	25UAM126
3. Shubham Khavare	25UAM102
4. Suyash Mali	25UAM107

Have successfully completed the project work, entitled

"DIGITAL LITERACY FOR SENIOR CITIZENS"

In partial fulfilment for the award of degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning). This is a record of their work carried out during the academic year 2026-27.

Miss.S.S.Demanna
[Project Guide]

Prof. Dr. S. K. Shirgave
[Head of Department]

Date: _____
Place: Ichalkaranji

DECLARATION

We the undersigned students of S.Y.C.S.E.(AIML) declare that the Community Engagement Project work report entitled “DIGITAL LITERACY FOR SENIOR CITIZENS” written and submitted under the guidance of Miss.S.S.Demanna is our original work. The empirical findings in this report are based on the interactions and data collected by us. The matter assimilated in this report is not reproduced from any readymade report.

Name	**PRN**
1. Pranav Mane	25UAM105
2. Sanskar Gorave	25UAM126
3. Shubham Khavare	25UAM102
4. Suyash Mali	25UAM107

Date: _____

Place: Ichalkaranji

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INTRODUCTION

In today's rapidly digitalizing world, everyday tasks such as banking, healthcare access, communication, and government services are increasingly moving online. While younger generations adapt quickly to smartphones, computers, and the internet, senior citizens often find themselves left behind due to limited digital exposure and a lack of confidence in using new technology. The "Digital Literacy for Senior Citizens" project was undertaken to address this widening digital divide by designing and delivering a structured, practical, and senior-friendly digital literacy and awareness program.

The primary goal of this project is to make digital technology approachable, safe, and useful for older adults. The program focuses on teaching basic smartphone and computer operation, safe internet browsing, digital payments and UPI transactions, and awareness of common cyber frauds and scams targeting senior citizens. Each session is designed around hands-on practice, allowing participants to build confidence by actually performing tasks themselves under guidance rather than only observing a demonstration.

For senior citizens, the project offers more than just technical training — it restores a sense of independence and connectedness. Many elderly individuals depend on family members for tasks as simple as making a digital payment or video-calling a relative. By providing an accessible, patient, and repeatable learning experience, the Digital Literacy for Senior Citizens project empowers participants to perform these tasks on their own, improving their quality of life and reducing their dependence on others.

In conclusion, this project is more than a training exercise; it is a community engagement initiative that addresses a real and growing social need. Its structured methodology, focus on safety and confidence-building, and emphasis on hands-on learning make it a meaningful contribution toward building a more inclusive, digitally aware, and connected society for senior citizens.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Many senior citizens face difficulties in using smartphones, computers, and online services due to limited digital knowledge and a lack of confidence. As a result, they struggle to access online banking, healthcare services, digital payments, government portals, and communication platforms, making them dependent on others for even routine digital tasks.

This digital divide leaves millions of senior citizens isolated from essential services and increasingly vulnerable to online fraud, as they are often unaware of common cyber security risks. The Digital Literacy for Senior Citizens project addresses this problem by providing structured, hands-on training that builds both digital skills and confidence, while also creating awareness about safe and secure use of digital platforms.

PROBLEM DESCRIPTION

In the modern world, essential services such as banking, healthcare, and government schemes are increasingly delivered through digital platforms. However, a large section of senior citizens remains excluded from this transformation. Most elderly individuals rely on family members, neighbours, or younger relatives to perform basic digital tasks such as checking a bank balance, making a UPI payment, or filling an online form, since they lack familiarity with smartphones, applications, and the internet.

This dependence often leads to delays in accessing time-sensitive services, feelings of helplessness, and in some cases, complete avoidance of digital platforms altogether. Furthermore, the absence of awareness about cyber security makes senior citizens easy targets for online scams, phishing calls, and fraudulent payment requests — a risk that is amplified by their limited ability to identify warning signs of fraud.

There is also a significant gap in the availability of structured, patient, and senior-friendly digital training. Conventional digital literacy programs are often designed for younger, tech-savvy audiences and move too quickly for older learners, who benefit more from repeated hands-on practice, simplified instructions, and one-on-one support.

The Digital Literacy for Senior Citizens project addresses these problems by providing a structured, step-by-step training program tailored specifically to the pace and needs of older adults. Through hands-on sessions, printed reference material, and dedicated cyber-safety awareness, the project helps senior citizens gain the confidence and competence to use digital services safely and independently, ultimately reducing their dependence on others and protecting them from digital fraud.

FACILITY REQUIREMENTS RELATED TO THE PROBLEM

To deliver an effective digital literacy program for senior citizens, the following facilities are required:

1. **Trained Volunteers/Instructors:** Patient, well-trained volunteers capable of teaching at a pace comfortable for senior citizens.
2. **Demonstration Devices:** Smartphones, tablets, and computers available for hands-on demonstration and practice.
3. **Accessible Training Venue:** A quiet, comfortable, and easily accessible venue with adequate seating and lighting.
4. **Senior-Friendly Training Material:** Large-font printed handbooks and step-by-step guides in simple language.
5. **Internet Connectivity:** Stable Wi-Fi or mobile data for live demonstrations of banking, UPI, and communication apps.
6. **Mock/Demo Accounts:** Safe demo environments for practicing digital payments without financial risk.
7. **Cyber Security Awareness Material:** Posters, handouts, and case examples of common online frauds and scams.
8. **Feedback and Assessment Tools:** Simple feedback forms to assess learning outcomes and areas needing more support.
9. **Helpline/Follow-up Support:** A contact point for participants to seek help after the training sessions conclude.

FIELD VISIT

As part of the Community Engagement Activity, the team visited a local senior citizens' welfare association in Ichalkaranji to understand the real-world digital challenges faced by elderly residents. The visit aimed to interact directly with senior citizens, observe their comfort level with smartphones and digital services, and gather first-hand insights to design a more effective and relevant training program.

Purpose of the Visit

- To assess the current digital literacy levels among senior citizens in the community.
- To understand the specific digital tasks they find most difficult or intimidating.
- To identify prior experiences with online fraud or unsafe digital practices.
- To gather feedback on preferred learning methods (group sessions, one-on-one guidance, printed material, etc.).

Key Observations

- Most participants owned smartphones but used only a few basic functions such as calling and messaging.
- Many were unaware of safe practices for UPI payments and were hesitant to use them due to fear of making mistakes.
- Several participants had received suspicious calls or messages but were unsure how to identify or report them.
- Participants expressed strong interest in learning, provided the pace was slow and instructions were repeated as needed.

The insights gathered during this field visit directly shaped the structure and content of the training methodology, ensuring that the program addresses genuine, observed needs rather than assumptions.

FIELD VISIT PHOTOS



Image 1 : Visiting Rotary Club, Ichalkaranji for Community Engagement Program (Senior Citizens Digital Literacy Awareness Program)

TECHNICAL SOLUTIONS ON PROBLEM

To effectively address the digital literacy gap among senior citizens, the following practical and technical solutions were designed and implemented as part of the training program.

1. Structured Hands-On Training Modules

Description:

Step-by-step training modules covering smartphone basics, internet browsing, and communication apps, broken into small, manageable sessions.

Implementation Strategies:

- Use short 30–45 minute sessions.
- Allow repeated practice.
- Pair each participant with a volunteer for individual guidance.

Benefits:

- Reduces cognitive overload.
- Builds confidence gradually.
- Improves retention of learned skills.

2. Simplified, Senior-Friendly Learning Material

Description:

Printed handbooks and guides using large fonts, simple language, and clear step-by-step screenshots.

Implementation Strategies:

- Avoid technical jargon.
- Use numbered steps with visuals.
- Provide take-home reference copies.

Benefits:

- Enables self-paced revision at home.
- Reduces dependency on trainers for repeated queries.

3. Guided Digital Payment (UPI) Practice

Description:

Supervised, hands-on practice using demo or low-value transactions to build comfort with digital payment applications.

Implementation Strategies:

- Use sandbox/demo modes where available.
- Start with small, real transactions under guidance.
- Explain each screen before proceeding.

Benefits:

- Builds real confidence through safe practice.
- Reduces fear of making payment errors.

4. Cyber Security Awareness Sessions

Description:

Dedicated sessions teaching participants to recognize phishing calls, fraudulent messages, and unsafe links.

Implementation Strategies:

- Use real-life case examples.
- Conduct simple role-play scenarios of scam calls.
- Provide a checklist of "warning signs."

Benefits:

- Directly reduces vulnerability to fraud.
- Empowers participants to make safer decisions independently.

5. Buddy/Mentor Support System

Description:

Pairing each senior participant with a student volunteer for one-on-one guidance during and after training sessions.

Implementation Strategies:

- Assign consistent volunteer-participant pairs.
- Schedule periodic follow-up check-ins.

Benefits:

- Provides personalized support.
- Builds trust and encourages participants to ask questions freely.

6. Feedback and Follow-Up Mechanism

Description:

Structured feedback forms and follow-up contact to assess learning outcomes and address remaining difficulties.

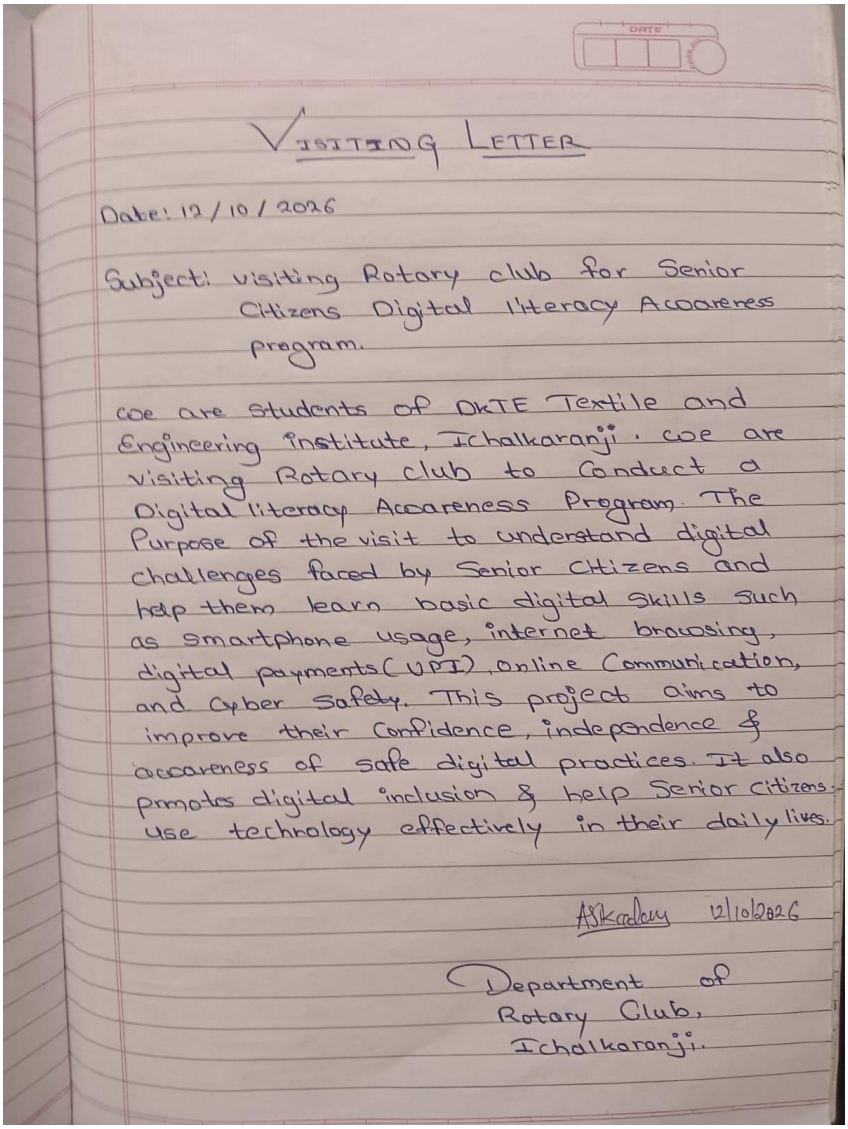
Implementation Strategies:

- Collect feedback after each session.
- Maintain a helpline or contact number for post-training queries.

Benefits:

- Helps measure the program's effectiveness.
- Ensures continued support beyond the training period.

AUTHORITY LETTER



VISITING LETTER

Date: 12/10/2026

Subject: visiting Rotary club for Senior Citizens Digital literacy Accareness program.

coe are students of DKTE Textile and Engineering institute, Ichalkaranji. coe are visiting Rotary club to Conduct a Digital literacy Accareness Program. The Purpose of the visit to understand digital challenges faced by Senior Citizens and help them learn basic digital skills such as smartphone usage, internet browsing, digital payments(UPI), online Communication, and Cyber Safety. This project aims to improve their Confidence, independence & accareness of safe digital practices. It also pmotes digital inclusion & help Senior Citizens use technology effectively in their daily lives.

ASKadday 12/10/2026

Department of
Rotary Club,
Ichalkaranji.

CONCLUSION

Digital literacy is no longer optional in a world where essential services — banking, healthcare, communication, and government interactions — are increasingly delivered online. Senior citizens, despite being a significant part of society, are often left behind in this transition due to limited exposure, confidence, and awareness.

Through a structured methodology of field-based needs assessment, hands-on training, and dedicated cyber safety education, the Digital Literacy for Senior Citizens project successfully bridged this gap for the participants it engaged with. The program not only improved participants' practical digital skills but also reduced their dependence on others for routine digital tasks and made them more aware of online fraud risks.

Overall, the project demonstrates that with patience, structured guidance, and community engagement, senior citizens can be empowered to use digital technology safely and independently — ultimately fostering greater confidence, independence, and social connectedness in later life.

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